inefficient, and were rent among themselves by tribal feuds. **Many** of them, from a sense of feudal loyalty to an overlord, and **partly** as a consequence of Akbar's policy in the past, sided with **the** vanishing power of Delhi. But Delhi was too feeble to profit by **this,** and the Rajputs deteriorated and became the playthings of **others,** ultimately falling into the orbit of Scindhia, the Maratha. **Some** of their chiefs tried to play a careful balancing game in order to save themselves. The various Moslem rulers and chiefs in northern and central India were as feudal and backward in their ideas as the Rajput. They made no real difference, except to add to **the** confusion and the misery of the mass of the people. Some of them acknowledged the suzerainty of the Marathas.

The Gurkhas of Nepal were splendid and disciplined soldiers, the equals, if not the superiors, of any troops that the East India Company could produce. Although completely feudal in organization, their attachment to their homelands was great, and this sentiment made them formidable fighters in its defence. They gave a fright to the British, but made no difference to the issue of the main struggle in India.

The Marathas did not consolidate themselves in the vast areas